

Answer Key

Grade 3 Intermediate Passages

1. The Mislabeled Jars

1. What is the problem with the jars?
D. The labels are gone, so salt and baking soda look the same.
2. How does Amira tell the powders apart?
C. She adds vinegar and watches which cup foams.
3. What does the group use for the real test?
D. The jar that foamed in vinegar

2. Pages Out of Order

1. What is wrong with Noah's folder?
A. The song pages are out of order.
2. How does Noah fix the order?
D. He stacks the pages by the numbers in the corners.
3. What keeps the pages from getting mixed again?
A. A paper clip holds the corner of the stack.

3. The Askew Lid

1. What problem does Priya notice?
B. Water is leaking from the terrarium onto the table.
2. Why doesn't the lid sit flat?
B. A pebble is holding up one side.
3. How is the leak stopped?
A. Priya moves the pebble and reseats the lid.

4. The Wrong Garden Bed

1. What is wrong with Diego's pictures?
D. They show the tomato bed instead of the beans.
2. Why are Diego's shots missing?
B. The card was full of another group's photos.
3. How does Diego fix the report?
A. He clears the card with Ms. Alvarez and reshoots the beans.

5. Tape on the Stage

1. What is missing at rehearsal?
A. The tape marks that show where actors stand
2. How do Lila and Omar know where to put new tape?
D. They follow the diagram in the prompt book.
3. What does Lila do so the marks will not be cleaned away?
C. She leaves the janitor a note about the tape.

6. The Clogged Sink

1. What is happening to the classroom sink?
A. It fills because a paper towel is stuck in the drain.
2. Why doesn't Rosa reach into the drain?
A. She gets Mr. Cole, who uses tongs and a light.
3. How does Rosa try to stop the clog from happening again?
D. She posts a sign that towels belong in the bin.

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7. Ten Minutes Fast

1. What problem does the fast clock cause?
B. Jade's group almost misses the assembly.
2. How does Jade find out what is wrong?
C. She compares the classroom clock with the office clock.
3. How is the problem fixed?
B. Ms. Patel resets the classroom clock to match the office.

8. Seeds Too Close

1. What is wrong with Owen's seed tape?
B. The seeds are clumped instead of spaced apart.
2. How does Owen know the spacing is wrong?
A. The packet says two inches, and his clumps are closer.
3. What does Owen do next?
D. He rebuilds the tape with even gaps and plants it.

9. The Noisy Nook

1. Why is the reading nook a problem?
A. It is beside a busy door, so readers lose their place.
2. What does Andre do before anyone moves the rug?
C. He asks Ms. Ortiz and they measure a quieter corner.
3. Why does the new spot work?
C. It is away from the door, so the noise is farther off.

10. The Jammed Sharpener

1. What is wrong with the sharpener?
B. Shavings and a broken lead have jammed it.
2. What does Luis do before he opens the case?
B. He unplugs the sharpener.
3. How does the story end?
C. The sharpener works, and Luis tells others to empty it.

11. Two Feedings

1. What is the problem at the hutch?
A. Thistle was fed twice because the chart was confusing.
2. What does Nina do with the extra pellets?
C. She scoops them out so the bowl is back to normal.
3. How do they keep the mix-up from happening again?
C. Nina rewrites the chart in pen with one name per day.

12. Brushes Left Overnight

1. What happened to the paintbrushes?
B. They were left in water and the bristles bent.
2. How does Hana reshape them?
A. She rinses them and smooths the wet bristles.
3. What new job does Hana add?
A. Wash the brushes and lay them flat to dry.

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13. The Shed Lock

1. What problem does Theo have at the shed?
C. The lock will not open when he starts with the wrong number.
2. What mistake does Theo notice?
A. He was starting with the last number, as on his gym lock.
3. How does he help the next person?
D. He hangs the card inside with an arrow for the first number.

14. Tickets and Seats

1. What goes wrong with the tickets?
A. Two families have tickets for the same seats.
2. How does Hector fix the double-sold row?
A. He numbers the seats and moves one family to row D.
3. What does Hector do with the unsold tickets?
C. He numbers them to match the empty chairs.

15. Stickers on the Glass

1. What happens at the start of the story?
D. A robin hits the window and is stunned.
2. Why do the birds fly at the window?
C. The glass reflects the sky, so it looks open.
3. What solution do Elena and Ms. Alvarez try?
B. They put dot stickers on the glass so birds can see it.

16. A Spoon, Not a Cup

1. What mistake does Sam make?
D. He uses a tablespoon of salt instead of a teaspoon.
2. Why can he still fix the batter?
B. The pan is not in the oven yet.
3. How does Sam keep from repeating the mistake?
C. He clips the teaspoon to the card with a note.

17. Numbers on the Back

1. What is wrong before the team photo?
D. Some jersey numbers are pinned on backwards.
2. How does Malik check his own number?
B. He looks in a mirror and compares it to the list.
3. How does the story end?
D. The numbers read correctly in the camera.

18. Shelved by Color

1. What is wrong with the shelf Sofia finds?
B. The books are grouped by color instead of by author.
2. How does Sofia reorganize the books?
B. She stacks them by the authors' last names, then shelves them.
3. How does she know the shelf is right?
A. The first and last books match the shelf labels.

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19. The Dripping Spigot

1. What problem does Cole notice?
C. The rain barrel is dripping and losing water.
2. Why doesn't tightening the handle fix it?
B. A cracked washer inside the spigot still leaks.
3. What finally stops the drip?
A. Cole puts in a new washer and screws the spout back on.

20. The Low Note

1. What is wrong with the first run of the song?
C. The chorus starts too low and sounds flat.
2. How does the group find the right pitch?
A. Mr. Ellis plays the starting note and they hum it.
3. What do they add to the rehearsal plan?
B. A reminder to give the pitch before they sing

21. Cards in Time

1. What is wrong with the timeline?
D. Events are clipped up in the wrong time order.
2. How does the group handle the blurry date?
A. They check the town booklet instead of guessing.
3. How can a visitor tell the timeline is fixed?
B. The years climb from left to right.

22. The Wrong Size Box

1. What is wrong with the shoe box?
C. It is marked size 3 but holds adult sneakers.
2. What does Ivy do besides fixing that one box?
D. She checks five more boxes by looking inside.
3. Where does she put the new labels?
B. On the front, so helpers see them before opening the box

23. Metal and the Needle

1. What problem does Mei have with the compass?
C. The needle points at the bleachers and will not settle.
2. What is pulling the needle off course?
C. The metal clipboard is too close to the compass.
3. How does the group get back on the course?
B. Mei holds the compass away from the clipboard and restarts.

24. A Clear Headline

1. What is weak about Noor's first headline?
D. Big Day does not say what happened.
2. What is the article mostly about?
D. Third grade collected 214 books.
3. Why does the new headline work?
B. It names the grade and the number of books.

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25. Too Close to the Speaker

1. What happens when Omar tests the microphone?
B. A screech comes from the speaker.
2. Why does the screech happen?
B. The mic is so close that the speaker's sound loops into it.
3. How does Omar keep the next announcer from causing the screech?
A. He marks where the mic should stand and writes the volume.

26. The Celery Test

1. What is Lucy's problem?
B. Her celery stays pale while the other stalks turn blue.
2. What does she change?
A. She cuts a fresh end and keeps the same dye.
3. What does Lucy decide caused the problem?
D. The old brown cut would not let water in.

27. Slides in a Line

1. What is wrong with the slides?
A. They are in an order that shows the ending first.
2. How does Camila fix the order?
C. She drags the slides to follow the note cards.
3. What does she do so the slides will not scramble again?
D. She locks the slide order.

28. The Worn Washer

1. What happens when Jordan turns on the hose?
C. Water sprays from the connector instead of the nozzle.
2. What does he find inside the connector?
D. A cracked, thin rubber washer
3. How does Jordan know how tight to make the hose?
A. The diagram says hand-tight, not tool-tight.

29. Lined Up by Height

1. What problem does Ben have on stage?
A. A taller student blocks his view of the director.
2. How does the row reorganize?
D. They line up from shortest to tallest.
3. What helps the next rehearsal start in the right order?
C. Floor tape and a folder labeled Row order

30. A Brace for the Board

1. What happens to Leo's science board?
C. It folds and falls because the taped hinge is too soft.
2. What do Leo and Dad add?
D. A cardboard triangle that braces the back
3. How does Leo know the brace works?
B. The board stays up even when the next display is bumped.